

Flat Chat

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC

Austin-Healey

The Lynas 100



DECEMBER 2013-JANUARY 2014

**VALE BEN SELLERS
A 100 IN PAKISTAN
AHOC DISPLAY DAY
AUSTIN-HEALEYS AT THE V8S**

KAS Kilmartin Automotive Sheetmetal Pty. Ltd.



Contact us now for a Parts/Price List

Since 1982, we have expanded the total range of products we manufacture to over 800 parts and cater for **Austin Healey, MG and Triumph**. Our extensive range of quality chassis repair sections, body rust repair panels and trim ware are made with an emphasis on originality. We supply parts to anyone from the one off local restorer to the major overseas trade houses. Whether your car be a 100S, 100M, 4 Cyl, 6Cyl, or Sprite we have the right part for you.



We provide to you a part with the right shape and fit. We use a blend of traditional techniques and latest technology to provide you the very best product for your restoration.



3 Laidlaw Drive, Delacombe, Ballarat, 3356

Phone: 03 5335 6940

Fax: 03 5336 2681

Email: kas@ncable.net.au

Web: kas-kilmartin.com.au



SALES **CUMMINS** SERVICE
CLASSIC CARS



- SALES AND SERVICE OF CLASSIC AND SPORTS CARS
- SPECIALISING IN ALL

AUSTIN HEALEY MECHANICAL WORK

WWW.CUMMINS CARS.COM

33 Hilly Street Mortlake Sydney NSW 2137
T 02.9743 4479 F 02.9743 5783 MD 20325

PENINSULA SPORTS CAR SERVICES
BRITISH & CLASSIC CAR SPECIALISTS 9907 2069



- ▶ PRECISION ENGINE BUILDING & TUNING
- ▶ DYNO TUNING FOR MAXIMUM PERFORMANCE & ECONOMY
- ▶ HANDLING KITS FOR IMPROVED ROAD HANDLING
- ▶ RACE CAR PREPARATION
- ▶ REGO INSPECTIONS

QUALITY REPAIRS & SERVICE TO ALL BRITISH SPORTS CARS AT REASONABLE RATES

- ▶ SPRITES & ALL MGs OUR SPECIALITY
- ▶ EXTENSIVE RANGE OF MG SPECIAL TUNING PARTS
- ▶ PENRITE & BRAD PENN OIL STOCKIST

37 WINBOURNE RD, BROOKVALE N.S.W 2100

PH: (02) 9907 2069

EMAIL: g Morse@optusnet.com.au

www.peninsulasportscars.com



Flat Chat is the official publication of the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc., and is published monthly by Parabola Publishing Pty Ltd

Contributions from members are welcome, however the Club accepts no responsibility for the accuracy, reliability or opinions of any article or correspondence herein.

The Club's postal address is:
AHOC (NSW) Inc, PO Box 2754
North Parramatta NSW 1750
(ABN: 87 630 303 136)

Email:
austinhealeynsw@ozemail.com.au

Website:
www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

Contributions for the magazine can also be emailed to the editor at:
p_cquinn@tpg.com.au

AHOC Club meetings are held at the Rydalmere Bowling Club, Park Road, Rydalmere on the 2nd Wednesday of each month, commencing at 8pm. Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner at the bistro from 6:30pm.

Flat Chat Editor
Patrick Quinn



ON THE COVER

Read all about the extended history of Gordon and Louise Lynas' 100 starting on page 10. Cover insert photos show the car in the UK including the one on the right taken on the date it was purchased by brother David Lynas in 1960.

Flat Chat

DECEMBER 2013

THE JOURNAL OF THE AUSTIN-HEALEY CLUB (NSW) INC

DEPARTMENTS

- 4 President's Report
- 5 Exhaust Notes
- 6 Secretary's Report/Minutes
- 8 Annual General Meeting
- 8 Librarian News
- 22 Austin-Healey Marketplace
- 24 Back Page Pics

FEATURES

- 9 Vale Ben Sellers
- 10 The Lynas 100
- 17 Moment in Time
- 18 A 100 in Pakistan
- 20 On the Homefront



DATES FOR YOUR DIARY 2014

FEBRUARY

- 4 Oasis run to Wollondilly Heritage Centre
- 12 Monthly Meeting
- 19 Committee Meeting
- 19 GEAR Wakefield Park
- 22/23 HSRCA Historic Meeting-Wakefield Park

- 12 Monthly Meeting
- 19 Committee Meeting

APRIL

- 5/6 FoSC Wakefield Park
- 9 Monthly Meeting
- 16 Committee Meeting
- 16 GEAR Wakefield Park

MARCH

- 2 Run to Mt Tomah Botanical Gardens
- 8/9 Phillip Island Classic

If you have any questions about the above events either look at the Club's website at www.austinhealeynsw.com.au or contact our club secretary Gordon Lynas on (02) 9944 4789

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

JOHN KENT (02) 9498 8193



As we move further into the New Year I would like to thank the Club's Committee for 2013 as they have met many challenges during the year with enthusiasm and dedication. Many of those members have been re-elected for 2014 which provides for a high degree of continuity of the Committee into 2014.

There are a number of Committee positions that were not filled, Social Secretary, Magazine Editor and Competition Secretary. If any member has an interest in any of these positions please discuss your interest with a member of the Committee.

The one position that is looking difficult to fill is that of Magazine Editor, a position that was so admirably discharged by Patrick Quinn, who does not have the time available to produce a quality monthly publication. Your Committee is looking at a number of options to deliver the information re Club matters, such as monthly newsletters with a larger magazine on a quarterly basis that would relate to Healeys and Austin-Healeys in all states of Australia. This matter is subject to on-going discussions and was the basis of some discussion at the Delegates Meeting at our last National Rally in Canberra

The Club Christmas party was held on Saturday 30th November at the Epping Club. While attendance was disappointing and the club had to fund a shortfall in numbers it was an excellent evening with high quality food and drinks paid for by the AHOC. During the evening Terry Bancroft was presented with his life membership plaque.

The presentation breakfast was held at Alan and Vicky Mitchell's house at 6 Dorsett Road Marulan on 19th of January. All those who attended enjoyed their breakfast so ably prepared by Terry and Patricia Bancroft.

I wish all members a safe and prosperous New Year and hope that everyone enjoys their vehicles especially their Austin-Healeys.



Left: The general throng at the Christmas party held at the Epping Club on 30 November 2013. Right: Terry Bancroft accepting his life membership plaque.



Left: Anne Read, Brian Jones & George Goodare at the Christmas party. Right: Geoff Smith, Eric Rudd & Keith Drake were no doubt discussing pistons and bearings.

CLUB COMMITTEE

2013

Club Patron
Ross Bond

President
John Kent
38 Barrie Street, East Killara, NSW 2071
(02) 9498 8193 • 0419 497 033 mob
ckent@bigpond.com

Vice President
John Sherman
40 Gladstone Street, Newport NSW 2106
(02) 9997 4000 bh
johnsher@ihug.com.au

Secretary
Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road, Terrey Hills NSW 2084
(02) 9944 4789 gordonlynas@optusnet.com.au

Treasurer
Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave., Wyoming NSW 2250
(02) 4328 4582 ah
0413 589 306 mob • jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Social Secretary
Vacant

Editor
Patrick Quinn
116 Warks Hill Rd., Kurrajong Heights NSW 2758
(02) 4567 7380 ah • 0417 673 065 mob
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Competition Secretary
Ian Clayton
71 Douglas Road • Blacktown NSW 2148
(02) 9920 0048 ah • 0411 162 110 mob
ian_clayton@shannons.com.au

Historian
Joe Armour
5/150 Abbotsford Rd., Picton NSW 2571
(02) 4677 3999 • sebring@hotmail.net.au

Membership Secretary
Christine Lyttle
PO Box 400,
West Ryde NSW 1685
0419 419 378 mob
christinelyttle@hotmail.com

Regalia
Terry Bancroft
PO Box 3027, Llandilo NSW 2747
(02) 4777 4883 • 0409 323 133 mob
bangers@bancroft.id.au

Technical Officer
Eric Rudd
762 Barrenjoey Road, Avalon, NSW 2107
(02) 9974 3773 ah • 0438 209 094 mob

Club Registration
Patrick Quinn (As Above)

Public Relations
Richard Horwood
(02) 9764 4000 • 0408 233 592 mob

Web Master
Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123, Marulan NSW 2579
0412 898 656 • mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions

Competition Assistant
John Kent
Librarian
Stuart McColl
CMC Delegate
Ray Roberts

Assoc of British Car Clubs Rep
Sue Darlington

Please do not call committee members after 9pm.

Flat Chat is published on behalf of the Austin-Healey Owners Club of NSW (Inc) by Parabolica Publishing Pty Ltd., 116 Warks Hill Rd., Kurrajong Heights NSW 2758

The opinions expressed in *Flat Chat* are not necessarily those of the Editor or the AHOC (NSW) (Inc).



Greetings and welcome to the December-January issue of Flat Chat magazine.

"But it's late January!" I hear you say. Well that's part of the reason for the next few words as unless there is divine intervention this happens to be my last edition of Flat Chat magazine.

As my predecessor Allan Whitehouse quite correctly said that four years is about enough to be doing this style of monthly magazine. Things are happening and I can no longer afford the three to four days a month that it takes to put together each issue of Flat Chat.

I must admit that I have absolutely enjoyed putting together each issue and I hope you have all enjoyed reading the same. I would like to say thanks to everyone who contributed over that period and I hope that my drivel has been of interest. On the positive side I must say that I have never had any difficulty in finding things to include in each issue, but then again I find that writing comes easy to me and writing about something I really love is very simple.

I suppose it's a confession, but I have said it before. It hasn't been just me who has put together each issue. Sure I edit and put the words together plus decide what goes where and that sort of stuff, but it's not me who does the actually laying out or making each issue look as pretty as it does. Over the last four years that's been done by a gentleman by the name of Brad Jansen who spends five days a week in front of a large screen inside a darkened room in Los Angeles, California.

All this is done through my involvement with Parabolica Publishing in the US who publish *Vintage Racecar-Roadcar* magazine of which I am also the South Pacific Editor. Really simple actually as everything is just a click away and after I send away the words and pics it all comes back nicely laid out. Thanks to Brad we have all enjoyed Flat Chat over the last four years.

Sorry to disappoint you, but I am not going away. Many members would be aware that I have submitted a proposal for a quarterly Austin-Healey magazine that is to be Australia wide covering clubs in each state. It's very early days for this and hopefully by the end of March you will find a 64 page glossy magazine in your letter box. Keep your fingers crossed that this will go smoothly.



So what's in this issue of Flat Chat? Well I have gone against the norm with our cover car as instead of the usual four pages it's been extended to seven. The cover car is the 100 of Gordon and Louise Lynas which has been in the Lynas family since 1960. It's such a good story that I thought the whole lot should be included.

When I joined the club back in 1972 its president was a gentleman by the name of Ben Sellers. Well sadly Ben has recently passed away and within this issue you will find a suitable number of words on him. Talking about presidents. Would you believe that the president of the Pakistan Vintage and Classic Car Club is a 100 owner? That's a good story too and you will find it on page 18-19. Now just perhaps you think I spend all my time punching away at this keyboard, I thought I would bring you up to date with what's been happening in the Quinn Healey and Austin-Healey household. If you would like a quick nap turn to page 20.

Also on this page you will find a photo of a cake. Yes a cake, but it's not just any cake. A few months back Caroline and I received a visit from club member Ian Grace. I first met Ian back in the early 1970s when he had a 100. He still has the 100 plus another. Before he joined us for morning coffee Ian said that he would bring a cake and bring a cake he did.

It was a professionally made rendition of the Austin-Healey wings on top of a white icing cake about 18 inches by 12 inches. It was simply amazing and we decided that it should be saved for a suitable AHOC occasion which was the Christmas party held on 30 November at the Epping Club. Needless to say the cake was a great success and I would like to extend our thanks to Ian for his generosity.

Thank you to everyone for your positive comments about Flat Chat over the last four years

Classic cover for your classic.

In our experience, we know your pride and joy deserves special care. That's why at NRMA Insurance, we've designed a policy especially for veteran, vintage and classic vehicles. Which means you can get the right cover, with complete peace of mind.

- ✓ Agreed value cover
- ✓ Retention of wreck
- ✓ Reduced premiums for club registered vehicles
- ✓ Traveller Care
- ✓ 24/7 Helpline

Call 1800 646 605 or visit nrma.com.au



NRMA
INSURANCE

To see if our Veteran, Vintage and Classic Vehicle Insurance is right for you, always read the Product Disclosure Statement from the product issuer, NRMA Insurance.

■ MONTHLY MEETING DATE:

13 OCTOBER 2013

MEETING COMMENCED: 8:09 PM

(At Shannons, St Leonards)

Apologies: John and Judy Sherman, Richard Horwood and Mal French.

■ MINUTES

- The President moved that the minutes of the September General Meeting published in the October Flat Chat be accepted.
- Moved: Alan Mitchell
- Seconded: Ian Clayton
- Motion carried.

■ PRESIDENT

• The president thanked Alan Whitehouse for organising the run to 'Lost in the Fifties' at Newcastle. It was an unbelievable collection and included a lot of 1950's memorabilia as well as cars. Also mentioned was the V8 Supercars at Homebush Bay. We still need 3 cars to parade the drivers around the circuit. Neville asked for names of those who will be providing cars. Dennis Lesslie will host a cherry day at Bathurst on Sunday 24 November. Vince Cessario is collecting names and numbers on Denis's behalf. The Christmas dinner will be on 30 November at the Epping Club. Contact Christine Lytle ASAP if you haven't yet booked your seats.

■ VICE PRESIDENT

- The Vice President had given his apologies hence there is no VP Report this month.

■ SECRETARY

The Secretary and Treasurer attended the CAMS workshop on 'Sponsorship Fund Raising and Grants' on 16 October. Suffice to say that our eyes were opened to the amount of funding that might be available to sporting organisations, and also to some of the difficulties facing AHOC in applying for such funding. The Secretary, Membership Secretary and Webmaster attended the CAMS Web Management for Sport workshop on 6 November. Your new committee will have some interesting discussions about the issues and opportunities presented at these workshops, and will consider how best to use our new knowledge for the benefit of the club. A letter of appreciation will be sent to CAMS for presenting each of the workshops.

Mail Received

- Thank you card from Katherine Roughley
- Australia Post - Bill for underpaid postage \$25.20
- Extreme Marquees - car club discount - www.extrememarquees.com.au
- Olympia Motel Queanbeyan flyer
- Glenmore Park Takeaway - Big Breakfast every Sunday morning 8am - noon.
- Enquiry from Bill Metcalfe (Vic) re champagne Austin-Healey at the Annual Rally - passed to Patrick Quinn
- Shannon's Supercar Showdown flyers for episodes 4, 5, 6 and 7
- News from Denis Welch Motorsport - report on Netherland's AH meeting
- News from Denis Welch Motorsport - report on Jerez Masters Historic Festival and Algarve Classic Festival.
- Invitation to visit High Valley Wine & Cheese Co., Mudgee

Mail Sent

- Thank you card from Katherine Roughley
- Australia Post - Bill for underpaid postage \$25.20
- Extreme Marquees - car club discount - www.extrememarquees.com.au
- Olympia Motel Queanbeyan flyer
- Glenmore Park Takeaway - Big Breakfast every Sunday morning 8am - noon.
- Enquiry from Bill Metcalfe (Vic) re champagne Austin-Healey at the Annual Rally - passed to Patrick Quinn
- Shannon's Supercar Showdown flyers for episodes 4, 5, 6 and 7
- News from Denis Welch Motorsport - report on Netherland's AH meeting
- News from Denis Welch Motorsport - report on Jerez Masters Historic Festival and Algarve Classic Festival.
- Invitation to visit High Valley Wine & Cheese Co., Mudgee

Mail Sent

- Thank you letter to GPT Rouse Hill Shopping Centre re. our display day.
- Enquiry to Lockhart Council re. possible publication of wool art in Flat Chat - Reply agreeing to this has been received

Thank You Cards sent to:

- Geoff and Margaret Smith - catering for recent breakfast run.
- Neil and Glenda Thew - thanks for organising the annual Charlie's Run.
- Also Thank you cards (sent via the Thews) to all motels catering for the Charlie's Run members.
- Terry Cornelius at the Panel Repair shop in Corowa to thank him for the talk he gave to members on Charlie's Run.
- Terry and Patricia Bancroft - thanks for organising the Tasmanian Run.
- Thank you cards also sent to motels catering for members participating.
- The Healey Factory - thank you card for assistance rendered on two occasions for members needing parts during the Tassie Run. (Despite regular maintenance and pre-run preparation.... we experienced some very inclement weather and rough roads, which contributed to breakdowns. The Healey Factory organised to open on a weekend, and later....also to overnight parts to Tassie) Thanks to Robbie and Crew!!
- Mr Brett Gillow - Tasmanian Tourist Bureau - thanks for his very personal assistance ... particularly when several members were affected by bushfire and had to return early to NSW. All arrangements were made for their return with no stress for them.
- Acknowledgement and Thanks - sent via John Burch (who missed Charlie's Run) - to John and his Fire Brigade colleagues to say thanks for the work they all did during the crisis - which affected our members so personally.

Congratulations Card:

- Sent by Anne Read to Steve Pike on his nomination for world restoration award. (Steve rang Anne to say thanks.... he appreciated the club sending a card).
- Congratulations card sent to Ian Clayton's family on the birth of their new grandchild.

Get Well Cards:

- Colin Goldsmith - wishing him a speedy recovery from back injury.
- Kathryn Roughley - wishing her a return to health.
- John Thornton - wishing him a return to full health after some radiation treatment.

Thinking of You Card:

- Sent to the Sells on behalf of the club, after the loss of their home from bush-fire.

Useful Items

- Our Car Club - Management system flyer
- New Item from AH Spares Ltd - 6 cylinder inlet manifolds (BN4, 6 port)
- Martez Engineering - fabricator of engineering components - www.martezengineering.com.au
- CAMS Event Entry (CEE) online system announcement

Events Notified - See Events Calendar below

Magazines Received

- Healeys West November 2013
- Hundreds and Thousands - November 2013
- BMC Leyland Australia Heritage Group Newsletter - October
- Matters of the Mount - October
- Rally Directions - October
- Austin- Healey South Africa Newsletter - October

Videos notified

An Austin Healey must watch <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UD7TjvMkHKO>

■ WEBMASTER

The Website now has all of the forms for the *WA National Rally Easter 2014*.

Alan has also updated it to include all events of which he is aware.

Photos from Tuesday's run have been put on the website and the events calendar has been updated.

■ TREASURER

Treasurers Report for General Meeting 13 November 2013

Account Balances as at Thursday 31 October 2013

Main Account	\$2,586.89
Main Account	\$2,586.89
Cash Reserve Account	\$20,623.48
Debit Card	\$1,922.60
Term Deposit	\$50,000.00
Term Deposit	\$15,000.00
Total	\$90,132.97

less

Charlie's Run A/c	\$628.05
Member's Funds	\$89,504.92

• Charlie's Run has been completed and all accounts now have been paid. After cheques have been presented there will be a surplus of \$343.00 to be held against next year's run expenses. Total members' funds remain almost unchanged from last month.

• Donations have been made to the Royal Flying Doctor Service of \$100.00 out of the surplus from the Brass Monkey Run and to the Salvation Army Bush Fire Appeal of \$830.00 from a collection from Charlie's run participants.

• The term deposits for \$65,000 matured on 5 November. The principal, plus interest of \$2,523.19 and an additional \$2,476.81 from our Cash Reserve account, a total of \$70,000, has now been invested in a further term deposit at a rate of 3.35% maturing on 3 April 2014. Previously the rate was 4.05%.

• Membership fees are starting to come in and, as at 31 October, \$1,530.00 had been received for the 2014 / 2015 period; however this will be offset by the subsidy that the club is making to this year's Christmas party.

■ MEMBERSHIP

• Fees are due at the end of November. Invoices have been issued and some payments have been received. The President reminded the members that current renewals are valid until 30 June 2015 as we are changing the membership year to harmonise with our financial year.

• 38 members attended the Meeting, and 5 Austin-Healeys were present.

■ SOCIAL SECRETARY

• Position Vacant

Club Events Calendar

• 17 November - Annual club inspection day at Edwin Street Mortlake.

• 24 November - Cherry picking courtesy of Dennis Lesslie.

• 30 November - Christmas Party at the Epping Club

• 6 December - Homebush Bay - Healeys and drivers for the drivers parade

• 19 January - Presentation breakfast at the home of Vicki and Alan Mitchells

• February 2014 - Breakfast run to Southern Highland Wines.

Other Events Notified

• 16 -17 November - Open Weekend - Powerhouse Discovery Centre Castle Hill 10am-4pm

• 23-24 November - Queanbeyan Swap-Meet - Queanbeyan showground

• 30 November - CAMS NSW Motor Sport Awards Dinner - Rydges Mt Panorama

• 30 November - 1 December - Geelong Revival Motoring Festival - www.geelongrevival.com.au

• 8 December - HMAS ALBATROSS Show 'n' Shine-Nowra

• 26 January 2014 - Minnamurra Rotary Club Annual Classic and Antique Vehicle Show - Kiama

• 26 January 2014 - CARNivale flyer

• 2 March 2014 - Wellington Vintage Fair

• 8 March 2014 - Tea Gardens - Hawks Nest Motorfest 2014

• August 2014 - Pebble Beach - www.classicdrivingtours.com

• September 2014 - Goodwood Revival - www.classicdrivingtours.com

• Route 66 Discovery Tours 2014 - www.route66discoverytours.com.au

■ EDITOR

• Next issue is under way. Thanks to contributors for items on the Tasmanian and Charlie's runs.

• Downloads from You-Tube will be shown at a future meeting. They will also be linked to the club website.

■ COMPETITION

• Three races involving Peter Jackson and Brian Duffy changing places many times in each race. Lap times almost identical and only 3/100ths of a second separated them at the finish.

■ HISTORIAN

• Austin-Healeys racing - 1966 was Joe's first association with Austin-Healeys. At that time he recollected that he had difficulty finding any fellow Austin-Healey owners. By 1969 the nascent Austin-Healey Owners Club had its first meeting. At that time swapping parts at BBQs and scouring wreckers' yards for second-hand parts was the main activity. There were lots of 100s, in those early years and a few 100-6s and Mk 1 3000s. There were some notable members in the early years, such as Steve Pike, who at that time was an enthusiastic but inexperienced Austin-Healey fan. Since then Steve has gone on to restore a number of cars.

• Recently NOJ 393, the (in)famous 100S that was involved in the fatal Mercedes Benz crash at Le Mans in 1955 received the Pike treatment. That car has now been shortlisted for 'Restoration of the Year' at the International Historic Motoring Awards. Judges including Derek Bell and Jochen Mass who now

have to deliberate the relative merits of: Jim Clark's 1966 USA GP-winning Lotus 43; an Allard Chrysler; a T51A Grand Prix Bugatti; and a Brabham BMW BT52 1983 World Championship car as well as NOJ 393. The winner will be announced on 14 December at the awards dinner at the recently restored and re-opened St Pancras Renaissance Hotel (which is itself an amazing restoration of a gothic Victorian railway hotel). (www.historicmotoring-awards.com for more details)

• The fact that Steve's work is now considered amongst the best in the world is a great tribute to him, and a reflection of the restoration skills and general standard of work here in Australia.

Finally, Joe noted that Steve Pike apparently has driven 38 of the 50 100Ss produced and worked on or restored 15 of them. ABL6 the last John Gott BMC rally team car is currently in Steve's workshop.

■ REGALIA

• National rally shirts are now available at the special price of \$15.

• Terry Bancroft also reported on the recent Tasmanian tour. It was apparently the worst of the seven tours that he has led. Strong winds, rain and cold accompanied them all the way together with rough crossings of Bass Strait both ways. Terry advised that the next Tasmanian trip will not be in October!

■ PUBLIC RELATIONS

• N/R

■ LIBRARIAN

• N/R

■ CONDITIONAL REGISTRATION

• Inspection day is on Sunday 17 November as usual at Edwin St., Mortlake courtesy of Richard Horwood for the venue, and Neville Stirton as examiner, to whom the club offers its thanks.

• The Registrar reminded members that it is the owner's responsibility to ensure that their car is road worthy. The club inspection only shows that the car is road worthy when inspected.

■ CMC

• N/R

■ GENERAL BUSINESS

• Display Day - The President thanked Neville Stirton for making it all happen.

Thank you letters have been sent to GPT and were expressed to Shannons for attending the event.

Members' choice - Brian Duffy - beat Robert Harrison by 1 vote. Perhaps Robert will not leave early from next year's display day?

• Alan Mitchell advised members that although entries for the Australia Day display, Carnivale, have now closed, it is still worth considering for a visit if you are not otherwise engaged on Australia Day. The cars will be displayed at Hyde Park.

• The RACV sponsored Motorclassica was attended by John Kent recently. He reported that in his opinion the event was somewhat over-commercial and expensive by comparison with other events. The auction achieved around 50% clearance. The exotica auctioned included a '68 Lamborghini Miura P400 with recent engine rebuild and other work done in Italy, and the oldest Holden in private ownership, KY400, a prototype of what would become the 'FX'.

• Patrick Quinn thanked all who contacted them during the recent fires. The BN3 was relocated to a safer place. He also thanked all those members who came to the Open Garden, despite the less than perfect weather.

■ SHOW AND TELL/FOR SALE

• BN1 for sale on behalf of a club member - contact Neville Stirton.

• Spare Parts list will be prepared by John Kent. He requested assistance in identifying and photographing each item for cataloguing.

• 2 BJ8s for sale - contact Patrick Quinn.

• Shown - sticker "Life is short - drive your Healey naked" - this is not recommended practice!

■ RAFFLE

• Prizes - book Austin-Healey 3000 and 100-6 - The Road & Rally Cars

Meeting concluded at 8:35 pm

The 2013 Annual General Meeting of the Austin-Healey Owner's Club (NSW) Inc. was called to order at 8:35pm at Shannons, Reserve Rd, St Leonards, NSW.

Stuart McColl was appointed to conduct the meeting.

The Minutes of the 2012 AGM were published in the January 2013 Flat Chat. A motion to accept the minutes was proposed by Terry Bancroft and seconded by Patrick Quinn. The motion was carried.

The Treasurer's Report for the 2011-12 financial year was published in the September 2013 Flat Chat together with the Club Profit and Loss Statement. A motion to accept the Treasurer's Report was proposed by Alan Mitchell and seconded by John Kent. The motion was carried. All committee positions were declared vacant for the purposes of electing a new committee for 2014.

Single nominations had been received for each of the following roles: President, Vice President, Treasurer, Secretary, Membership Secretary, Club Registrar, Regalia, and Public Relations. Richard Horwood withdrew his nomination for P/R before the AGM. There being no further nominations for these roles, the nominated members were:

Elected Officer	Name	Nominated by	Seconded by:	Elected Y/N
COMMITTEE POSITIONS:				
PRESIDENT	John Kent	Gordon Lynas	Jim Phillips	Yes
VICE PRESIDENT	Geoff Smith	John Kent	Gordon Lynas	Yes
SECRETARY (& Public Officer)	Gordon Lynas	John Kent	Jim Phillips	Yes
TREASURER	Jim Phillips	Gordon Lynas	John Kent	Yes
MEMBERSHIP SECRETARY/Billeting	Christine Lytle	John Kent	Jim Phillips	Yes
CLUB REGISTRAR (Conditional Registration)	Patrick Quinn	John Kent	Gordon Lynas	Yes
PUBLIC RELATIONS				
REGALIA OFFICER	Terry Bancroft	Gordon Lynas	Jim Phillips	Yes
WEB MASTER	Alan Mitchell	Gordon Lynas	John Kent	Yes

Nominations were called for the remaining positions, and candidates duly elected by the members as indicated:

Editor, Competition Secretary, Social Secretary, Public Relations, and Display Day Co-ordinator roles remained unfilled.

Elected Officer	Name	Nominated by	Seconded by:	Elected Y/N
COMMITTEE POSITIONS:				
COMPETITION SECRETARY				
EDITOR				
HISTORIAN	Joe Armour	John Kent	Patrick Quinn	Yes
SOCIAL SECRETARY				
TECHNICAL OFFICER	Eric Rudd	John Kent	Patrick Quinn	Yes
NON-COMMITTEE POSITIONS:				
ASSOC BRITISH CAR CLUBS REP	Sue Darlington	Terry Bancroft	Gordon Lynas	Yes
CMC DELEGATE	Ray Roberts	Joe Armour	Rod Richards	Yes
COMPETITION ASSISTANT	John Kent	Gordon Lynas	Joe Armour	Yes
DISPLAY DAY CO-ORDINATOR				
INSPECTOR	Neville Stilton	John Kent	Joe Armour	Yes
LIBRARIAN	Ron Strange	Colin Rule	Geoff Smith	Yes

There being no other business notified for the AGM, the meeting was closed at 9:20 pm.

Librarian News

Highly Recommended Reading – Ronnie Strange

BS or Bart Levy's trilogy "*The Last Open Road*", "*Montezuma's Ferrari*" and the final and most interesting "*The Fabulous Trashwagon*".

They should be read in sequence as there is a continuance of fictional characters throughout the books.

Although fictional, these books are about factual events at real race meetings featuring many real racing drivers from the early to mid-1950s. The Austin-Healey 100 is well featured in the second and particularly the third book. Apart from the 100 which had just come on the market, there's a lot about Jaguar 120s and C-types, Triumph, Aston Martin, MG and other English sports cars, plus American Cunninghams and Cobras, Italian OSCAs and more.

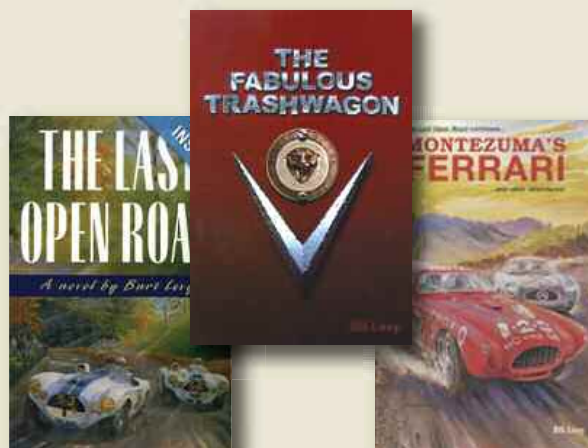
This is a long story about our hero, Buddy Palumbo, a 19 year old service station mechanic and his family. Set in New Jersey, it covers four very amusing and realistic years of his life.

There are many real sportycar events from Road America, Sebring, Watkins Glen and finally "on the spot" coverage of the 1955 Le Mans race.

Buddy's girlfriend, fiancée, wife is less than supportive of his sportycar addiction and that in itself is worth the read.

Donald Healey and the Streamliner at Bonneville receive good coverage and we are reminded of the music, films and TV of that period.

I read these on a Kindle and there are about 2000 pages. Each book costs around \$10.00.





Sadly I have to pass on the news of the passing of Ben Sellers. To many members Ben's name will not be known, but he was the president of our club for a number of years during the 1970s.

I can't recall whether it was April or May 1972 when I first met Ben Sellers. I walked into my first meeting of the club, then held at the Leyland Theatre at Zetland. I was twenty years of age and apart from liking the shape of Austin-Healeys I knew absolutely nothing.

It was my first visit to a meeting of any form of club and I recall wondering why these two blokes were sitting up the front and facing everyone else. There was one bloke doing all the talking and the other was writing a lot. The talkative one I soon found out was the president of the club and his name was Ben Sellers while the one busy with the pen was Alan Jones, the secretary of our club.

Over the next few years they were both to play a significant part in my life, especially where Austin-Healeys were involved. However with the passage of time they are both no longer with us.

Ben was an automotive engineer who worked for Higginbottom Engine Reconditioning and was happy to assist his fellow club members when it came to engines for their everyday cars. When I first met him Ben owned a 3000 Mk2 roadster (now in Victoria), but that was about to change.

When Ross Bond put his 3000 up for sale, Ben was quick off the mark and it was soon his, meaning that the Mk2 was sold to Doug Treloar who would go on to become AHOC treasurer. Sadly Doug is also no longer with us.

I vividly recall club runs with Ben taking the lead in the Bond 3000 and back then it certainly wasn't in the beautiful condition it is now. Its paint was in terrible condition, the trim was non-existent and the body would shake, rattle and roll. However Ben loved the car and used it to lead the club in all events. It was not uncommon to see the Ben and the Bond 3000 setting FTD at hillclimbs, lap dashes and motorhomas. It was a significant day when Ben set the first sub-40secs ascent at Silverdale Hillclimb.

Ben's ability to wield a spanner was well known and he was quite happy whether it was his car or someone else's. When I rebuilt the engine of the 100 I had at the time, it was Ben who started it and made it really sing.

Ben was married to Elaine and while we very infrequently saw her at club events, she always had a cheery hello to the frequent visitors to their home at Guildford. Her patience was legendary, even with members still working on their cars way past midnight.

Ben would eventually sell the Bond 3000 and soon after



Ben and Alan Jones just after the V8 engine had been removed from Alan's newly imported 100S.

built up a 100 for competition. That was sold too, but he stayed on as AHOC president despite his protestations at not being an Austin-Healey owner.

The mid-70s saw Historic Motor Sport on the rise and five of the six founding members of the Historic Sports and Racing Car Association were also AHOC members. Ben was also attracted and bought the *Nota Major* followed by the Lotus 23 lookalike *Stirling*. It was a common sight at Historic events to see Ben out in a number of cars including the 100S that was owned at the time by Ray and Muriel Roberts.

Time eventually passed with Ben and Elaine moving to the western side of Lake Macquarie. A 100 in pieces was soon bought and then sold. However Ben's health was deteriorating, a fact that he kept to himself. Sadly in November his heart was to give away while at home.



Ben Sellers enjoying his own company at the Sydney Showground in 1974.

Love at First Sight



We all know the saying that good things come to those who wait. I received the first photos for this month's cover article back in October 2011 and I waited, and waited and waited a little more. Can't say that I'm not a patient bloke!

Well I must say that I am please I waited because the words and photos received from Gordon Lynas about the Lynas 100 were worth waiting for.

I recall meeting Gordon and Louise some years back, not long after they joined the club. It was at Richard Horwood's Mortlake-by-the-Sea gentleman's residence. Gordon and Louise hadn't long joined the club and had come along to have their car inspected for Conditional Registration. I assumed that they hadn't long beforehand bought their car and when told that it had been in the family since 1960 I was astounded.

So after the aforementioned long wait the below was received, not just from Gordon, but also from his brother David who first bought the car first.

Normally I would restrict cover car stories to four pages or somewhere between 1,200 and 1,500 words, but as I thought the story of the Lynas 100 such a good one I thought it should be run in its entirety, with a little editing of course.

Love at First Sight

by David Lynas

It was August 1960, I had seen twenty summers and not only was she stunning, but the feline curves were breathtaking. Con-

finied behind plate glass she was beautiful and had to be liberated and I had to have her. Was it love at first sight? Did I believe that nonsense? One way to find out!

She was in a glass fronted small showroom in Northallerton, North Yorkshire, an open two seater sports machine, old English white with chromed knock-off hub caps and silver wire wheels. 'She' was an Austin Healey 100.

This was a time when feline curves were not to be taken for granted. A family hack was, in fact, a family hack. Fifty miles per hour was the norm and at sixty mph one was really going places. Cars like Jaguar, Mercedes and Bristol were in the minority. Ford and Vauxhall were making some capable cars and the E-type had been around since 1959 but the AC Cobra, closer in appearance to the 100 was in 1960, yet to make a debut. Although I peered through plate glass in 1960, this 100 had been around since 1955.

The salesman sported a magnificent RAF handlebar moustache and looked more like Jimmy Edwards than Jimmy Edwards. Possibly wary of my youth, but more probably seizing an opportunity and the Healey liberated at last from confinement, he drove with considerable verve. Fourth gear, I should mention that the first gear blank had been removed, a flick up into overdrive and top down we were soon hurtling along at 80mph with 3,300rpm on the clock. The moustaches fluttered on the slipstream.

This was the prelude to seven years of very enjoyable motoring



during which the Healey carried me and several other fortunate souls the length and breadth of England.

Working in the Midlands, I would spend a weekend at home in the north every couple of months. Monday mornings necessitated a 5am departure, breakfast at Fortes, Ferry Bridge, coffee and the newspaper at my pad and arrival at work prior to 8.30am.

Full Cry

Those journeys were accomplished, most of the time, with the Healey at close to full cry at 90mph. Times were different, roads were more interesting and drivers generally courteous. Traffic, of course, was comparatively light; only one family in ten owned a motor car.

Across seven years of ownership, events of major excitement

were rare, but we did have a couple, the Healey and I, both, at least in part related to inconsistent road signage.

On one occasion the minor road we travelled breasted a small rise to dive off left at a right angle whilst the power poles which had misled me marched straight on across a field. Brake in a straight line, release, steer left and leave room for the tail to swing out, opposite lock all the way, and thank my lucky stars on negotiating the corner whilst remaining in one piece. The family munching sandwiches in the gateway, toward which the Healey had been heading at speed, presumably resumed their munching but I decided that I would not hang around to apologise.

Event number two occurred whilst travelling the M5 in filthy





winter conditions. The car was up to the eyeballs in the kind of slop that is thrown up by vehicles on Britain's winter roads, the one-speed wipers just clearing two apertures in the mud.

The motorway was under construction and unknown to me terminated a couple of miles beyond our coffee stop. The usual 'End of Motorway' signage did not exist and was represented by a puny temporary sign half obscured by mud. The situation was compounded by the fact that I chose the wrong moment to divert my attention to the screen washers. The motorway ended in a vicious hairpin, curling back on itself. It would subsequently be an access slip road. The hairpin bore down upon us at 70mph. Same technique as before, same good fortune. We negotiated the obstacle, completely rounding the curve, to finish up facing the direction in which we had been travelling, rolling slowly back into a sand pile!

Autobahn

In 1963 the 100 and I negotiated German Autobahns on a trip to Switzerland, Austria and Italy. We camped on the banks of Lake Luzern. The magic of dining beneath the stars by Swiss lakes remains with me to this day, as does driving up onto the pavement in a traffic jam somewhere in Belgium, because the car was overheating.



Another vivid memory is push-starting the car at Vitznau, Switzerland, when the charge system failed and we had to drive to a company called Ferier Gudeln in Zurich for a spare regulator. The highlight of that trip, however, had to be crossing the Gross Glockner Hoch Alpine Strasse from Austria, over the Alps to Italy. It was raining, and low cloud clung around the ravines, but the top was down, we wore plastic rain macks and Alpine hats, and the Goulash at the summit was great. The sun shone subsequently on green pasture and well fed cows all the way down to Italy.

Other memorable trips of course were often those of everyday journeys in England, in summer with the top down and the smell of cut grass heady on the air, and trips in snow across the Pennines in winter when I had a girlfriend in Hoylake, beyond Liverpool, which coincidentally had been the Healey's first home town in 1955. The lack of traffic in those days was another bonus.

My relationship with the Austin-Healey ended in 1967, when my youngest brother, Gordon, acquired ownership. It was February, a terrible month in England. The Healey had initially been treated more as a toy than everyday transport, but in later years had become an everyday essential. Twelve years old, she was not coping too well with standing on industrial construction sites in all weathers and was pretty miserable at ten o'clock at night. So I bought a Mk 2 Jaguar and the Austin-Healey was consigned to the garage at our parent's home for an indefinite period.

Henrietta: Half a Century of love and Neglect

1967 to 1987 UK to Australia

by Gordon Lynas

"Why don't you buy it?"

"Me??? How???"

Since David had consigned his Austin-Healey to temporary retirement in Dad's garage I'd spent a few hours each week sitting in it, running the engine (just to keep the battery charged and turn the oil over of course) and dreaming, just dreaming....

So, I started thinking: Age 16; Assets; one BSA 250 motor bike (bought for £5) and an extensive train set. Selling both of those



provided the cash to buy the car, but I was still no closer to driving it than my previous dreaming. Funds for road tax and insurance had still to be found.

A summer job as a deck chair attendant on Redcar 'prom' helped. That was one of the least demanding jobs ever, as there were not many sunny days that summer. Still, it put enough in the bank for 12 month's road tax. A stint on the Christmas Post gave me the wherewithal for insurance (Third party, fire and theft).

It was 1968 and the 'dream time' was over! I had a car I could legally drive. Whoopeeeee! So, off I went, up Redcar Lane for my first Austin-Healey cruise. I stopped at the junction, checked that nothing was coming, into gear, right foot squeezes the accelerator, I slip the clutch..... and shoot off backwards down the lane!!!! That gear selector required a delicate touch to avoid going into reverse instead of first. Still does come to that, but I'm used to it now.

That was the first of many adventures in this car. She served me well for three years travelling across the Pennines from Teesside to Manchester in all sorts of weather. Then for another three years in London where she became acquainted with the 'Old Bull and Bush', the 'Swiss Cottage', and many other North London pubs, as well as taking me back to Manchester and Redcar, and many points in between at regular intervals as well as taking me to work every day.

Little Tired

By 1975 Henrietta was looking a little tired to say the least. One day I made the mistake of tapping the passenger side door sill and the bottom fell out. It was time for action. Steel panels were no longer available for 100s but reasonable fibre glass ones were. So for £36 47p I acquired a set of four wing panels and two flat sheets of fibreglass coloured Old English White for replacing the lower door skins. Fibreglass might not be considered authentic these days, but it did have the double advantage that it was available and doesn't rust. No small consideration in a country where the authorities spread salt all over the roads in the winter to de-ice them. We all know what salt water does to steel and it is not pretty. Anyway, I acquired a Ford Zephyr as transport, and put the 100 in the garage where I proceeded to remove the rust, replacing it with varying thicknesses of glass fibre: no problem with the authorities on that, so long as it was not structural.

I thought it would take six months to restore the car to being the pretty thing I had bought seven years previously. Well, first there was work that got in the way in the form of a couple of stints in Saudi Arabia. So, the Zephyr gave way to a Bond Bug - 700ccs of genuine adrenalin, and a car that you could always park within 100 metres of where you wanted to be, even in the West End!

Then I upgraded to an MGB GT, which I thoroughly enjoyed, particularly in the winter and when it rained. The Austin-Healey



For the very best in motor upholstery

Specialists in sports, classic and historic cars
Where hoods and tonneaus are still hand made
and customised for your car

CRAIG WALL & SONS PTY LTD
Unit 42, 9 Powells Road
Brookvale NSW 2100
Phone 0413 027 904

PLATINUM SMASH REPAIRS

*Specialising in Insurance
and Private Work*

TEL	FAX	MOB
02 9439 9552	02 9438 5671	0418 964 774



Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsmash.com.au
13 Waltham Street • Artarmon NSW 2064

David Lynas inspecting 'his' car.



was no closer to going back on the road, and the MG gave way to a Fiat 124 Sports Coupe which I still think one of the best cars I have ever owned. It was a shame about the metal fatigue in the body, which saw the back axle trailing links threatening to punch through the floor and the clutch cable mounting shear the bulkhead under the steering column mounts, but it was fun to drive, and very quick.

Then I bought a house, and that needed decorating and maintenance.

Then I met Louise, and somehow there was always something more interesting to do than work on any car.

The Austin-Healey was consigned to the backyard where she sat under a thick sheet of builder's plastic for the next three years, followed by a year in a barn. (Yes, she had a period as a 'barn find'). Then 1981 saw us move to Harpenden and a house with a garage and a workshop. Suddenly, working on the car did not depend on the weather, and the restoration restarted. Refurbishment of brakes, steering and suspension made her a safe car. A new wiring harness made the electrics work a lot better, and it looked like it might be nearing a roadworthy certificate.

Australia

That was when we decided to relocate to Australia, and the Austin-Healey again had to take a back seat to finding a job and a home.

By 1995 we were once again established in our home, and I had time for the 100. Unfortunately I then found out that Australians don't regard fibreglass quite as well as their UK counterparts when it comes to testing for roadworthiness. So a lot of my

work was consigned to the rubbish bin, and we started again.

After 15 years of neglect, corrosion had spread its fingers through the car. I found out how far when Eric Rudd called me. "You had better come and have a look at this," he said. "Oh just tell me." "No, no, you really ought to see this." So I did. Well, there are lap joints between the rear bulkhead and the inner wings. Salt water had penetrated into those laps with the result that I now had some lovely original steel panels connected together by rust! Eric said "One good bump in the road and the car would have fallen apart."

A week or two later Eric had stripped the car and mounted the chassis on a box trailer, which we towed to The Healey Factory where all the rusty bits were replaced, returning a lovely clean shiny green chassis to me a month or two later. Butler and Rudd then put it all back together, got the necessary blue form and with a set of club plates I had a car I could once more drive. It was now 1997 and my 'six months' restoration had taken 21 years to complete.

Sadly, what had been a nice set of panels in 1976 were looking decidedly ropery by 1997, but under the skin she was effectively 'as new'. I can still recall the look on Neville Stirton's face when I took the car for its first club inspection. Luckily, the look changed to a smile as he checked it over.

As I can't see much of the car exterior when I'm driving, the next priority was the interior. Something nice to sit on, and a bit of carpet and vinyl was required. I bought some seat 'skins' from AH Spares. So with new seat squabs, the skins fitted, some new carpets and trim panels the interior of the car was comfort-

able and looked good from where I sat behind the steering wheel. Some folk however tended to call her a '30 foot car', meaning she looked okay from that distance. Nevertheless she took us reliably on quite a number of day trips and Charlie's runs over the next 10 years.

Rebuild Three

Charlie's 2008 run challenged our cars by taking us up and over Thunderbolt's Way. All was fine until half way up the hill at which point she started spewing raw fuel out of the exhaust and lost all power. A couple of stops and advice from many club members got us to the top of the hill. I then found that at something around the legal limit she ran beautifully all the way to Walcha. The trick was to use the fuel that was pouring through one of the carburettors which had a slightly sunken float. It's amazing what just two grams of fuel in the float does to the valve operation. Chris Fitzpatrick had suggested what the problem might be, but it still took all day to find and fix the problem. We ended up having a fast evening run from Tamworth to Gulgong with headlights full on for most of the way.

Next morning we found problem number two. A flat battery! That little adventure won us the 'Hard Luck Trophy' for 2008. The irony was that the photo of our car that graced on the cover of the December 2008 Flat Chat was taken just before we began the climb up Thunderbolt's Way!

We returned to the UK in 2009 for a holiday and as we were staying not far from Southam, a trip to AH Spares was more or less obligatory. We had a look at their panels and ended up buying wings, bonnet and doors and bumpers. So when we got home we had to find a restorer and get started on renovation number three. O&S Sports Cars at Cromer does beautiful aluminium work, so they got the job. By 2011, after a few trials and tribulations fitting and fettling panels we had a beautiful car.

It's now on full registration so we can use it whenever we want. The photos show the work done and the results obtained, and we have to say that we are generally very happy with the car's appearance.

National Rally

Foolishly I thought that that should be the end of Healey traumas. So come 2012 we thought "Let's take the car to the National Rally". It seemed like a nice run up to the Sunshine Coast and a lovely location and hotel for the rally. We even went up Thunderbolt's Way again, just to prove we now could. The car performed beautifully, until we got to Stanthorpe. Back in 1980 we had been driving around Stanthorpe when our Valiant blew a head gasket and water bubbling up through the carburettor was not a good sign. Anyway that was 1980. This was 2012 and we had a nicely restored car hadn't we? Well Stanthorpe is obviously a fatal town for my cars. Only been there twice in 30 years, and broken down both times.

We were using alarming quantities of oil as became apparent



on the way to Toowoomba. We stopped at K-Mart for some cheap oil and attracted the interest of the mechanics in the K-Mart Service Bays. They were just cleaning up for the Easter weekend, this being 4pm on Thursday.

"Using a bit of oil?" enquired Murray, the service manager. "Just a bit" I said. "Want us to take a look?" "I'd be grateful." So they wheeled her into the workshop and proceeded to inspect the entrails. The verdict? "I don't think she's going to go much further. Where are you heading?" "Maroochydore." "Dean, call Budget and get these people a hire car." That was Murray being decisive and very helpful. So Dean did just that, and very thankfully we had transport.

FOR SALE OR LEASE?

Then Speak to Me

For best advice and outstanding results in all aspects of selling, buying, leasing or valuing your residential/commercial property. Over 40 years experience. AHOC member for over 25 years with competitive fee structure for fellow club members.

Richard Horwood A.R.E.I.

PRINCIPAL & REGISTERED VALUER 1006

T (02) 8765 1900 M 0408 233 592

F (02) 8765 1922

E mail@boulevardere.com.au

boulevardere
REAL ESTATE

www.boulevardere.com.au • 2 Bennett Street Mortlake
All correspondence to PO Box 236 Concord NSW 2137



What to do with the Healey? "No problem, just wheel her into the workshop and we'll lock her in until Tuesday." What wonderful people! Louise and I will be eternally grateful to them for turning a disaster into a minor inconvenience. They even drove us to the hire car office as it was getting close to closing time and there were no taxis in sight!

The National Rally was a great success, and I know everyone there had a great time. Our enjoyment was boosted by Peter Linn of the Queensland Club who very generously lent us a Austin-Healey to drive in the display day run, so although Henrietta did not get to Maroochydore we were not entirely Healeyless.

After Easter, Henrietta was trucked to the Gold Coast where The Classic Car Connection proceeded to strip the engine to find one slipped cylinder liner and two pistons that had been pierced by broken bits of rings.

When the liners were removed it became clear that all four had worn close to the top of the bore such that the top centimetre was almost completely severed from the main part of the liner. The worst one also had a section at the top missing. It seems that the engine had been sleeved from new as my brother and I had owned the car for all except for its first five years, and neither of us had had the bores sleeved. Perhaps this is a new piece of information for the historians?

Luckily, although one liner had been pushed up, the head was undamaged, so a new set of liners, and a set of high compression standard sized pistons fixed the damage and we were able to drive the car from Southport to Gloucester just in time to join 2012's Charlie's Run! This time the car performed beautifully except for a bit of an oil leak which we eventually traced to the engine back plate camshaft gasket.

Of course there were other little problems along the way, including needing a new set of tappets that had to be hard chrome plated to fit the oversized tappet bores. Who would

have thought a little bit of plating and grinding could be so fraught with difficulty just to find someone to do the work? Then there were the weeks that passed waiting for parts to be machined and returned. If anyone else has sloppy tappets I would strongly advise having the block bored and sleeved rather than plating the tappets as was done to my engine. The latter was great until the tappets wore out. Replacing them was a major exercise. If the block had been sleeved it would just have been a case of slipping in a new set of tappets.

What is next? The carpets are showing their age, and I have been fitting more fibre cement and other insulation to try to keep the passenger floor a little cooler. Louise in particular is hoping that my attempts will prove successful on this year's Charlie's Run.

I have driven the car off and on now for nearly half a century and it is still a very enjoyable to drive. I know there will be other problems ahead, a 58 year old car is just as likely to have a few problems as its slightly older owner. However for the moment Louise and I are thoroughly enjoying cruising around in the car, waving to other 'special cars' and chatting to anyone who shows interest whenever we park, and there is usually someone who likes the look of Henrietta! Just going to October's General Meeting evoked a broad smile and a cry of "beautiful car" from a complete stranger. Such things just add to the pleasure of being an Austin-Healey driver.



A couple of photos this month, both of which came my way by chance.

Back in the 1970s our club used to take part in interstate rallies with our Queensland compatriots in and around Coffs Harbour. Prior to the 1974 event Alan Jones and I along with Barry and Jill Darley from Brisbane did a recce of the area and decided on a number of places to visit. One of these was a picturesque spot on the road between Coffs and Dorrigo that was even equipped with a small grassed area, a picnic shelter and as a bonus a small waterfall.

The '74 event was held over the January Australia Day long weekend, but as luck would have it the heavens opened for days beforehand. It absolutely bucketed down for almost a week beforehand which made driving north in a BN1 all the more interesting. At some stage not only was there water coming in from around the windscreen, hood and sidescreens but from under the doors too – yes the water on some sections of the roads around Coffs was that deep.

On the Sunday the sun came out and while there was still plenty of water about it was quite pleasant as we all heading along the road to Dorrigo for a picnic lunch.

We all filed out of our cars while enjoying the view to the coast as well as the waterfall which had reached Niagara proportions due to the rain. Armed with our packed lunches courtesy of the motel everyone sat on the grass or in the shelter. Within minutes a woman's scream was heard and a number of people were standing rubbing desperately at their legs.

The place was riddled with leeches and within minutes the smokers amongst us were in great demand as once touched by the burning end the leeches would drop off. Needless to say we all quickly packed up and left.



The photo shows the attending cars on the road to Dorrigo which I came upon by chance when I was looking for photos of Ben Sellers. The gentleman with the red BT7 Mk2 was our then treasurer Doug Treloar who is also sadly no longer with us. For those who remember him that's Tim Bradley on the right in shorts scratching his leg.

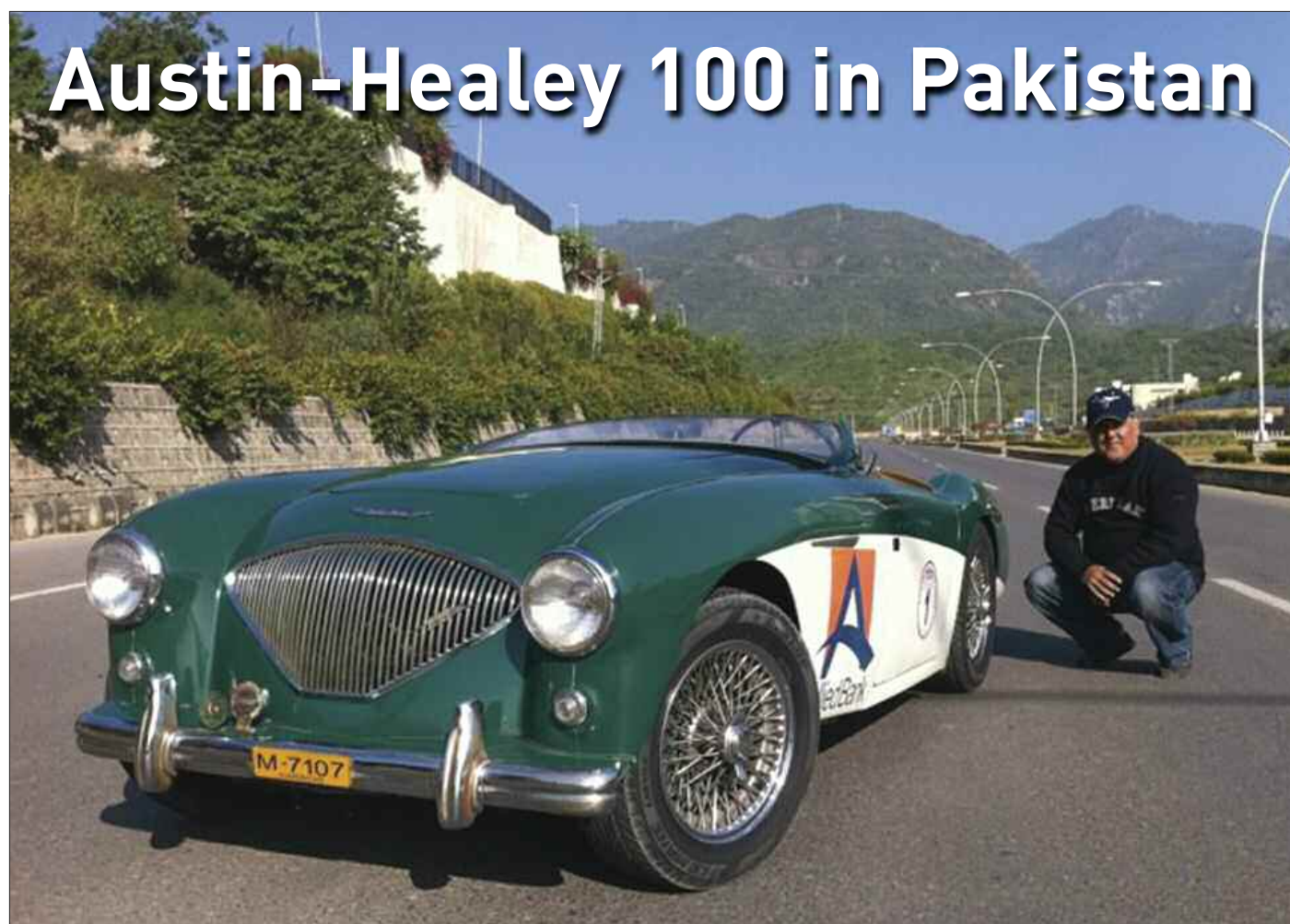
The second photo came my way by way small publication titled *'The Country Garage'* by Llyn E Morris and published by Shire Publications. The book tells the story of the English country garage and how it evolved from the dawn of motoring through to the start of WW2.

Tucked away on page 29 is a photo taken in 1917 and what it depicts is certainly of interest to us as Austin-Healey owners, despite that our favourite marque wasn't to be born for a further 35 years. It shows what is clearly an early motor garage in Peranporth, Cornwall and directly above the door opening are the words 'DONALD M. HEALEY'. Yes it's a very early photo of the garage that DMH set up after being invalided out of the Royal Flying Corps in 1917.

However I think the date of the photo is a little later than 1917 as the building to the right of the photo is clearly newly constructed and in a later photo on page 33 of *Donald Healey – My World of Cars* show that the words *Automobile Engineer D.M.Healey*. have been added to its façade. Also DMH's Discharge Certificate from the RFC was dated 16 November 1917.

DMH makes reference to the new building being erected with the financial help of his father and also refers to the purchasing of a number of charabancs (open single deck bus to you and me) and one in particular built on an American Garford chassis. Now if you look at the photo you will see that there is a charabanc parked out front and while my knowledge of Garfords is restricted to American fire engines, I would say that what it is. A very interesting photo.





Sometimes it's quite unusual how information arrives across my desk. Out of the blue comes an email containing a link to Mohsin Ikram the founder of the Vintage and Classic Car Club of Pakistan. Please see below a piece originally written by Phil Reeves and published by NPR News and if you want to know more you can either do a search on Facebook or have a look at www.vcccp.com

Patrick Quinn

Driving Pakistan's Badlands in a Vintage British Convertible

Every now and then you meet a character who stands out against the landscape. The landscape, in this case, is the sweep of terrain between the Arabian Sea and the Khyber Pass.

The character is a stocky man, wearing a baseball hat, dark glasses, a quirky grin, and an air of stubborn optimism. His name is Mohsin Ikram. The reason he stands out against this landscape is because he's motoring across it in a sports car that was made in Britain when Winston Churchill was still alive.

Traveling across Pakistan in a museum piece, with no roof, is not for the fainthearted. But Mohsin is a man in love. He is, he explains, in the grips of what he calls "this car thing"

— a burning, lifelong passion for vintage cars.

Pakistan was founded in 1947. There are still a few cars around that were shipped in here before that, under British rule.

Mohsin, who is 50, started collecting them when he was 16. His fleet currently includes a 1947 Lincoln Continental convertible that once belonged to the king of Afghanistan. "I would go out of my way to have fun in classic cars, go anywhere in the world, take any challenges," Mohsin says. "I love being around cars." Restoring classic cars is clearly Mohsin's life, but he does have a proper job — as a travel agent and events manager.

"I hate doing all that," he says. "I wish I didn't have to work for money and spent all my time on cars."

A Cross-Country Journey

Mohsin is the founder of Pakistan's Vintage and Classic Car Club. A few weeks ago, with a group of fellow enthusiasts, Mohsin set off from his home in the southern port city of Karachi and headed for Peshawar, close to Afghanistan. That's a journey of about 1,000 miles; Mohsin's wife, Saira, travels in the car with him.

Pakistan has some fine freeways and many new cars. But driving here is often also a battle with dust and potholes,

rickshaws, horse-drawn carts, cycles of all sorts, gaudily decorated trucks — and herds of goats.

Mohsin and Saira are traveling in a dark green 1954 Austin-Healey. When visibility is bad — at night, for example — Mohsin switches his dark glasses for a pair of glass and leather World War II flying goggles.

Mohsin and his friends started these road trips a few years back. They're partly just about enjoying their cars. They stop along the way to hold car shows and gatherings of fellow enthusiasts. But for Mohsin, this journey is also a statement of defiance against those creating havoc in his country.

"I am from that school of thought that this is our country, and we have to show them that we are living a normal life," he says. "We want to have fun. We will have fun, come what may." He continues: "I want to be free. I want to be free enough to go anywhere in Pakistan, wherever I want to go to. Why should a terrorist keep us off the streets?"

Pakistan isn't the kind of place that generally comes to mind if you're contemplating a leisurely cross-country drive. It's rare for a day to pass without a suicide bombing, a gunbattle or an assassination somewhere on the map. But the violence is patchy. In most trouble spots, there are very large areas where life carries on as normal. This is true here, too.

Avoiding a Trouble Spot

During the journey, Mohsin's convoy has to make a big detour because of a rumoured riot. He loses a fog lamp and breaks a spring after going off-road for hours to avoid a 60-mile traffic jam.

They eventually reach Islamabad, the capital, unscathed. Saira climbs out and allows this correspondent to squeeze into their car for a while.

"We are only 5 inches from the ground. It is a funny feeling. It's like a go-kart," says Mohsin, as the Austin-Healey growls its way through the city's wide avenues. "We get all kinds of reactions, but mostly people like what they see. They have smiles. They give me a thumbs-up; they appreciate the car. Some people laugh — I don't know why."

At this point in his journey, all that remains is the final leg, a three-hour drive to Peshawar.

More than 1,000 people have been killed or injured by bombings and shootings in that city this year. Mohsin is accustomed to this. In Karachi, there is bloodshed every day. But some of his group have told him they won't be going any farther because of security fears.

"Some people have dropped out because there's a warning that there might be some terrorist attack in Peshawar," Mohsin says. "I told them if you're not going, I am going

alone. And my wife said, if you're going, I am also going with you."

I watch as Mohsin and Saira and a handful of others, set off down the road to Peshawar on a dazzling blue autumn morning. Later I phone them; they'd made it, unharmed. Everything was — says Mohsin — "Fantastic!"

For the stubbornly optimistic Mohsin, these trips are making a fundamental point, about the impact that people can make by standing up to the men with guns. "People don't realize the people power," he says. "If we unite, if we get together, we can do anything."



The Classic Connection

Licensed Repairers and Body makers

We now offer:-

- * Prestige Painting
- * Panel beating and rust repairs
- * Insurance repairs to classic vehicles

As well as:-

- * Engine & gear box re-building
- * General mechanical repairs & servicing
- * Race car preparation & maintenance.

CAMS approved to measure and seal engines.

Secure storage space also available.

Ph: (02) 96271120 Fax: (02) 96271309

Units 2 and 3/29 Edward Street

Riverstone. 2765

Email: jdowsett@tpg.com.au

RePAIRer's Licence No: 28076



On the Homefront

I have kept quiet about the Quinn collection of odd British cars of late, but I thought that a page (or 2) of drivel might be graciously received.

After the engine of the Quinn Austin-Healey (the one without wind-up windows or a glove box) was completely rebuilt by Mike Dyer of Brookvale it returned home to receive a coat of dark green paint. That's the correct colour for the 100S and very early C-series six-cylinder (Morris-Wolseley) engines and my thanks to Steve Pike for the paint.

The engine sat in our barn for a time tempting me to install it. I knew that trying to squeeze a six-cylinder engine through the four-cylinder opening was going to be a challenge. So a call to our Technical Officer and mentor Eric Rudd had him agreeing to come along on the day.

That day arrived and Eric let on that he had spent a little time awake during the previous night wondering how it was all going to fit. So the engine, or should I say bare block was slung high. When I say bare it certainly was, except for paint. The problem in fitting the engine was that it had to fit completely over the front of the shroud opening before it hit the firewall. So there was no clutch or flywheel fitted, no sump, no cylinder head, no head studs and no harmonic balancer.

I am pleased to say that the day went gladly and as expected Eric was a true font of all the correct advice. The engine swung high, almost perpendicular and swung down into position. The engine mounts were then bolted into place after the engine was looking to be in the right place. We retired for lunch looking a little worse for wear. Not because it was physically hard work, but it certainly used up all available brain space.

A little time later I was speaking to that



From the look on Eric Rudd's face he is well pleased that the engine is well on to be refitted to the BN3.

metalsmith/painter extraordinaire Colin Rule who asked me how it was all going. The conversation turned to the sump, rocker cover and timing chain cover. Colin very correctly said that such things have to be done correctly as it's what people look at first. I couldn't but help to agree and in response Colin kindly volunteered to take them away to fettle and spray them. When he brought them back I was astounded as they looked unbelievably wonderful. If there was a concours for sumps, rocker covers and timing covers, I would win!

Glove Box

Next it's on to the Quinn Austin-Healey that has wind-up windows and a glovebox. That's the Healey Blue one that's now been sold twice.

Its new owner is in Tasmania and part of the deal is to deliver it to him on the Apple Isle. Everything went smoothly until on the way home from the V8 Super Cars day at Homebush I had trouble selecting gears. Hydraulics? A new hose and rubbers throughout seemed to fix things until our son Mark took it for a drive and it became a clutchless Austin-Healey on the Great Western Highway.

No matter what Doug Ross might think you can't drive a clutchless car to Tasmania to present it to its new owner so soon I joined the ranks of those who have had fun removing a BJ8 gearbox. Eric Rudd said it could be the carbon thrust bearing or the clutch itself. I was going for the carbon bearing.

So armed with a serviceable carbon thrust out of the BN3 (Alert! Alert! Originality disclosure! – Yes the BN3 is fitted with a BJ8 clutch) I approached the unfriendly fibreglass



Thanks to Colin Rule the sump, rocker cover and timing cover are looking immaculate. Colin Rule Photo.

gearbox tunnel. So the gearbox was out by lunchtime, but alas the carbon thrust was intact. Then followed some degree of head scratching over lunch.

So out came the pressure plate and half way through came the reassuring sound of springs and bits of metal tinkling on the concrete floor. Yes the driven plate had broken up and it was quickly replaced by the plate that was previously fitted to the BN3. All works perfect and Tasmania awaits.

Just to show that all things that came out of the Donald Healey Motor Company aren't necessarily open cars, our Healey Duncan Sports Saloon is now domiciled in Australia. After a tortuous journey via the Suez Canal and Singapore the ship carrying the all-important shipping container arrived on the 13th January.

Within days (after shelling out even more \$\$\$ - including some for Luxury Car Tax!!!) I received notification from the Department of Agriculture that Quarantine officers found the car very interesting. I received a form advising that it had to be cleaned which was likely to cause some damage. The form including three little boxes that I could tick. The first one was to agree to the cleaning. The second box if ticked would allow the car to be exported out of the country while the third stated that if ticked it was giving my approval for the car to be destroyed.

Did I call a friend? Yes Caroline suggested that I should sit down quietly and read the form again. I did and clearly it said that cleaning was required. So I ticked where appropriate and signed. Two hours later came an email saying it was ready to pick up.

That's another story for another time and the car is now at a friend's placed to be gone over to see what needs to be done. Having the brake pedal going to the floor is a little disconcerting.

Yes in the flesh (or metal) it is a little different or perhaps quirky would be a better word. Hope to have it out and about soon.



The BJ8 gearbox about to be lifted out.



A less than complete clutch driven plate.



The Healey Duncan Sports Saloon about to be trailered from Port Botany. Caroline Quinn Photo.



SYD: (02) 9679 1990
WWW.HOOSIER.COM.AU

MEL: (03) 9338 7477
WWW.MOTORSPORT.COM.AU

HOOSIER MAHLE WHEEL KIRKEY CROW

WE ARE THE AUSTRALIAN DISTRIBUTOR FOR ALL THESE BRANDS AND PRODUCTS PLUS MUCH MUCH MORE

SUCKS -
LARGE RANGE OF BIAS PLY
AND RADIAL SUCKS
FOR 10" 13", 15" AND 16" WHEELS



VINTAGE T.D. -
NEW SIZES NOW AVAILABLE
TO SUIT HISTORIC SPORTS CARS

5.0X15 VINTAGE TD
120/590-15 VTD
135/620-15 VTD
5.5X15 VINTAGE TD



SPEEDSTERS -
185/70 R14 SPEEDSTER
185/65 R15 SPEEDSTER
205/60 R15 SPEEDSTER





It's been an interesting four years watching how the prices have changed on Austin-Healeys and bits and pieces that have come up for sale.

Before I started writing my last Flat Chat Austin-Healey Marketplace I lined up a total of 42 copies of the magazine starting with the March 2010 issue. In that first issue all that was there was a bunch of ads for things for sale. In the following issue I made the first comment about auction prices, specifically about a 100M that was passed in at US\$100K and a Healey Westland that sold in the US for a healthy US\$159,500. Then the next few issues were mainly focussed on six-cylinder cars such as a 100/6 that sold in Sydney for \$47,500 and newer models in the US selling for the mid US\$60s. Plus there was the occasional Healey boat too and particular one in the US that was powered by a C-series six-cylinder engine.

If you follow things for sale you will know that eBay always brings a few interesting things for sale. Things like hardtop vents that were selling for \$550.00 and a BN4 back in October 2010 that was selling for a reasonable \$21,000. I can't say the same for the \$1,789 being asked for a NOS

six-cylinder sump or the US\$950 sought for a copy of the Anderson/Moment Restoration Guide.

Of course the pinnacle of auctioned Austin-Healeys within the last four years wouldn't have to be the ex-1955 Le Mans 100S NOJ 393 that was sold in the UK back in December 2011 for £843,000. Since restored by Steve Pike here in Australia I wouldn't hazard a guess at what it's worth today.

Perhaps some observations would go astray!

The prices of six-cylinder cars have increased over the last four years and it's not the later cars more so than say a BN4. I would say that a BJ8 in the same condition as a BN4 will always command more dollars, but I think there has been a greater marginal percentage increase on the earlier six-cylinder cars than the BJ8s. However it remains the situation that those who want to join the ranks of Austin-Healey ownership will generally lean towards the later models. For some reason that see attractiveness in wind-up windows, a glove box and a fibreglass gearbox tunnel.

Scams abound of course and I must admit some enjoyment has been found in leading the scammers on. If you are looking at a 100M in Indonesia or US\$18,700 for a beautifully restored BJ8 in the US you can be assured that if it seems too good to be true, it probably is.

Back to prices and I can say that the cost of four-cylinder cars is escalating and has been doing so for the last 3 to 4 years. Why is it so? Well in my mind the cars represent an era when cars were uncluttered, very straightforward and now highly collectable. The 100 was the epitome of the period and to prove this just look at the cars of similar design of the period - note I said similar design - not ethnic origin. So that includes Siata, Cisitalia, Lancia, Jaguar, Ferrari and Maserati. Plus you are

far more likely to have your application accepted in any of the world's classic rallies if you are driving an Austin-Healey 100.

The only thing about these other marques is that they are now priced out of average hands. So where does that leave the four-cylinder 100? Simple to maintain, reasonably quick, strikingly good looking and easy to afford. Sorry to say that the likes of MG, Triumph and Sunbeam, while nice cars are not in the same financial league.

At the recent Bonhams auction at Goodwood two 100s were sold. A older restored BN1 went for the equivalent of Aus\$69K while a late BN1 which was supposedly fitted with a Le Mans kit during the 1960s and now sporting a number of Denis Welch improvements(?) went for Aus\$114K. A few months back a 100 at the Bonhams auction during Monterey Car Week went for \$108K. The '64 Sebring 3000 went for \$376K, but that's a different story.

Two years ago a 100M (yes it was genuine and not one of the 1,023 left of the 640 built) sold in Monaco for 155KEuros. If you park two AH100s next to each other, both in the same condition and one is a BN1 and the other a genuine BN2. The four-speed 100 will bring 15 to 20% more than the BN1.

If it's important to you we are all making a dollar or two on our cars, but if you are buying, buy carefully and wisely. Just recently two 100s were for sale on eBay in Australia. One in Melbourne and the other in Perth with the latter minus an engine and gearbox. The Melbourne car needed restoring and didn't get past \$10K and the Western Australian car likewise for \$19,900.

For Sale



1955 Austin-Healey 100 BN1. Fitted with chrome wire wheels. This car is finished in Healey Ice Blue and fitted with good trim. It is in very good condition and drives very well. Currently on full registration. For sale at \$42,500 ono. Please contact Neville Stirton on 0414 472 877





CLASSIC SPORTSCAR SPECIALISTS



CAR SALES

Our Classic Car Showroom Has Over 50 Cars For Sale

Talk to us if you are considering selling or buying a Classic Sports Car

RESTORATION / ACCIDENT DAMAGE

Trophy Winning Cars

Accident / Classic Car Insurance Repairs

From All Over Australia and Overseas

SERVICE

Regular Service and Safety Check

Classic Rally & Track Day Preparation

Mechanical Repairs / Improvements / Modifications

SPARE PARTS

Mail Order Parts Specialists



SPECIALIST AUTOMOTIVE COMPONENTS

DMD Australia manufactures high quality components for Austin Healey engines. The company's range has been developed to extract performance improvements while maintaining maximum reliability for both competition and road use. All new products are subjected to extensive dyno and competition testing prior to release.

646 Whitehorse Road, Mitcham (Melbourne)
www.healeyfactory.com.au Telephone: (03) 9872 3900

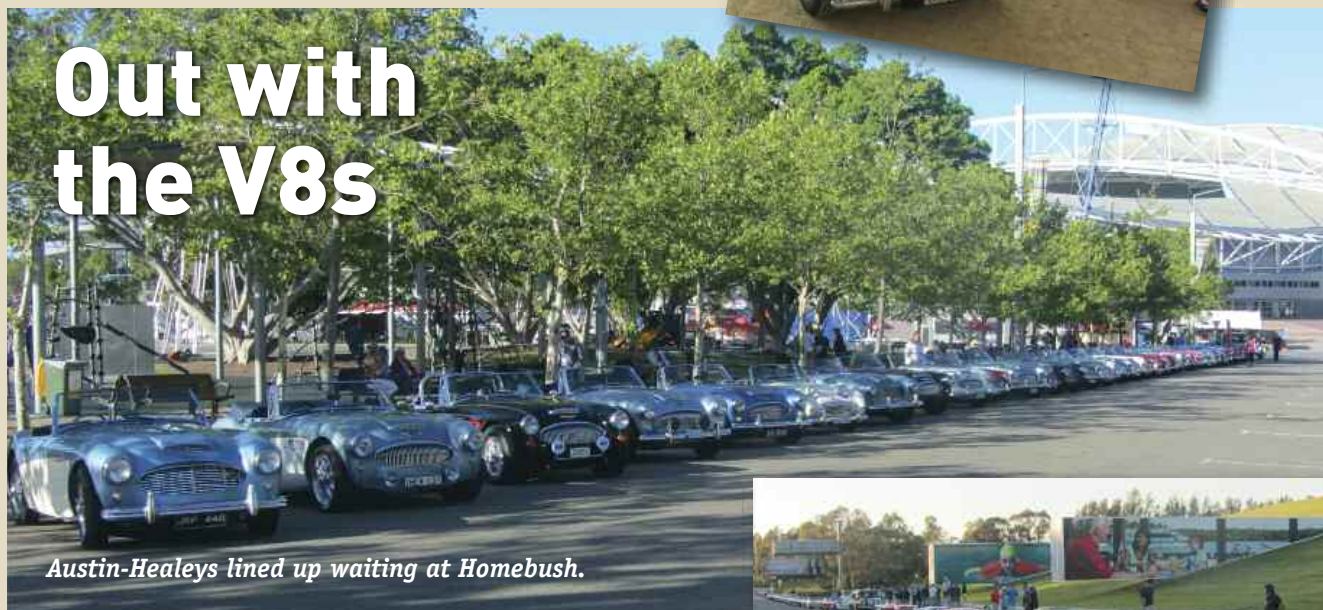
Display Day



Above: Austin-Healeys on display. Right: Don and Margot Hardie's 100 next to the BJ8 of Greg and Sue Denning.



Out with the V8s



Austin-Healeys lined up waiting at Homebush.



This is what 6.30 in the morning looks like.



On our way to pick up the drivers. David Williamson in his BJ8.



Too bad I couldn't find any empty flagons to accompany Doug Ross, Richard Horwood and John Kent.